

Dial KE 2-1661

Sunday, June 26, 1966

Tanner Sacrifices-- But Hopes To Get Goal

"I believe everyone must have a goal. My goal is to some day manage in the big leagues. And I believe everyone must sacrifice something in order to attain that goal."

Those were the words and the humble philosophy of Charles William Tanner Jr. — better known as Chuck Tanner — effervescent manager of the El Paso Sun Kings of the Texas League.

On July 4, Tanner will celebrate his 38th birthday. The Sun Kings will be home at Dudley Field against the Austin Braves in a doubleheader and the night has been set aside to honor Chuck as "Chuck Tanner Birthday Night."

In some measure, the Sun Kings hope to reward his enthusiasm and sacrifice by making it the biggest birthday party he has ever had. El Paso fans are invited to bring gifts to the park that night, or anytime prior to the Dudley Field office.

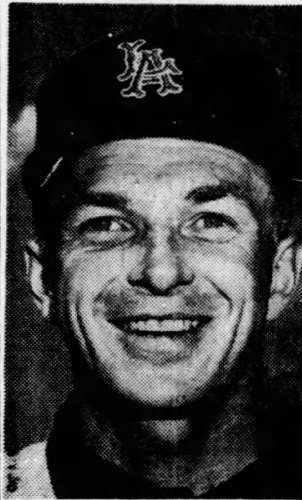
Chuck Tanner has been sacrificing most of his life in his baseball career. From 1946 when he was first signed by the Boston Braves to a no bonus contract and sent to Owensboro in the old Kitty League, Tanner has overcome critical physical injuries that threatened to end his career and only because of great heart and determination attained his first goal as a big league player with Milwaukee in 1955.

He distinguished himself that year when as a rookie outfielder he became the second player in major league history to hit a home run on the first pitch of his first time at bat as a pinch-hitter.

His big league career saw him move from Milwaukee, where he was a roommate of the great Warren Spahn, to Chicago Cubs in 1957, back to the minors with Minneapolis in 1959, and back to Cleveland that same year.

Tanner, his hustle and smile a baseball trademark, played under Andy Cohen in 1947 at Eau Claire in the Northern League where he hit .325. Today, Andy is his coach with the Sun Kings.

But back to sacrifice and its



CHUCK TANNER

meaning to Tanner. The father of four sons, Chuck has never seen them play baseball, though three of them are outstanding young athletes in New Castle, Pa. His lovely wife Barbara, whom he credits with keeping his morale high in baseball, has never seen her husband manage.

Seven months out of every year since he began managing in 1963, Chuck and his family have been separated by great distances with

the mail and telephone their only contact.

But the congenial Sun Kings' manager quite often will shyly produce home town newspaper clippings that recite glowing accounts of his 15-year-old son Mark, his 13-year-old son Gary, and his nine-year-old son Brent and their exploits in the youth baseball programs back home.

Does he work with them in the winter, teaching them the baseball tricks of the trade? "No, I have never told them a thing. Just let 'em play, because the guy whose managing them probably knows more about their ability as players than I do," said Tanner.

Mark this season is pitching and playing first base in the American Legion and Colt Leagues back home. "He's the best hitter in the family," said Tanner with that famous grin.

Gary, who celebrated a birthday Friday along with Brent, is an infielder and catcher in the Pony League, while Brent plays the outfield in Little League. Mark and Brent throw right and his left, just like their dad.

And then there's four-year-old Bruce coming up from the bench. "Sure I miss 'em," Tanner said, "but I believe you have to sacrifice something in life. When, and if, I make the big leagues as a manager, I'll have them with me and then it will all be worthwhile."

Coronado Sets Tourney

Coronado Country Club will hold a mixed-scrabble golf tournament starting at 12:30 p.m. Sunday at Coronado Country Club.

Pairings (12:30 p.m. starting time): Bill Crombie, Jeanne Miller, F. D. Schneider, Sandy Anderson; Irv Fortune, Betty Carrier John Lottin, Kate Crombie; Mary Hoover, Bob Miller, K. McIntyre, Ann Cohen; G. Dungan, W. Parsons, J. MacPherson, Jim Given; M. Willoughby, J. Parsons, L. Thompson, B. J. McNeil; S. Young Jr., Terry Hill, Bill Boyd, Billie Nance; Joe McNutt, T. T. Given, A. Aaronson, C. Massey; Dan Hill, Duchie Boyd, Danny Hill, L. Dungan; Jim McNeil, E. Lottin, Chip Cragin, B. Donaldson; Alan Schwartz, J. Thornton, Craig Hughes, Rita McNutt; F. K. Schneider, Anna Jo Thompson, Chip Ramsey, M. Fortune; Chris Thornton, Frances Bagwell, Davis Driver, Jim Nance; Joe Hoover, Patty Mayfield, Jim Morrow, Clint Bagwell.

Minor League Results

SATURDAY'S RESULTS

Pacific Coast League
Oklahoma City 7, Tacoma 2
Indianapolis 3, Denver 1
International League
Buffalo 5, Columbus 2
Toronto 16, Toledo 9
Eastern League
Waterbury 7, York 6
Elmira 8, Pittsfield 4
Southern League
Evansville 7, Macon 5

JONES TEAM WINS

Jones Harley-Davidson downed El Paso White Truck, 8-3, Saturday in El Paso Transportation Softball League play. Phillippe Mendoza got the win and was supported by homers by John Dominguez and Al Perez.